How to Install KDL OS

F9 Tech
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How to Install KDL OS — Simple Guide

You will have KDL OS running on your own computer in about 30 minutes. Most of that time is waiting for the first build.

You do not need any accounts or API keys.

Step 1. Install 3 things

Install this	Where to get it	Check it works
Git	https://git-scm.comSMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_59SMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_60	`git --version`
Docker Desktop	https://www.docker.com/products/docker-desktopSMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_71SMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_72	`docker --version`
OpenSSL	Already on Mac and Linux	`openssl version`

How to install Docker Desktop

1. Open the Docker link above and click **Download Docker Desktop**.
2. Choose your computer: Mac (Apple chip), Mac (Intel chip) or Windows.
3. Open the file you downloaded and install it.
4. Start **Docker Desktop**. Wait until it says **running**.

Give Docker enough memory: Docker Desktop → Settings → Resources → Memory → **8 GB**.

Windows users: do the Windows setup at the bottom first.

Step 2. Download the code

Open a terminal and type:

```
git clone https://github.com/F9info/kdl-os.git
cd kdl-os
```

Stay inside the `kdl-os` folder for all the next steps.

Step 3. Create the settings file

Copy this **whole block**, paste it into the terminal and press Enter. It makes a file called `.env` with new random passwords.

```
PG_PASS=$(openssl rand -hex 16)
REDIS_PASS=$(openssl rand -hex 16)
MINIO_PASS=$(openssl rand -hex 16)

cat > .env <<EOF
NODE_ENV=development
APP_PORT=4000
FRONTEND_URL=http://localhost
BACKEND_URL=http://localhost:4000
AI_SERVICES_URL=http://localhost:5000
CORS_ORIGIN=http://localhost,http://localhost:3000,http://localhost:3001
JWT_SECRET=$(openssl rand -hex 32)
JWT_REFRESH_SECRET=$(openssl rand -hex 32)
JWT_EXPIRES_IN=15m
JWT_REFRESH_EXPIRES_IN=7d
APP_ENCRYPTION_KEY=$(openssl rand -hex 32)
POSTGRES_USER=postgres
POSTGRES_PASSWORD=$PG_PASS
POSTGRES_DB=kdl_db
DATABASE_URL=postgresql://postgres:$PG_PASS@localhost:5433/kdl_db
REDIS_PASSWORD=$REDIS_PASS
REDIS_URL=redis://:$REDIS_PASS@localhost:6380
MINIO_ROOT_USER=kdl_minio
MINIO_ROOT_PASSWORD=$MINIO_PASS
MINIO_ACCESS_KEY=kdl_minio
MINIO_SECRET_KEY=$MINIO_PASS
MINIO_ENDPOINT=localhost
MINIO_PORT=9000
MINIO_USE_SSL=false
MINIO_BUCKET=kdl-media
MEILISEARCH_HOST=http://localhost:7700
MEILI_MASTER_KEY=$(openssl rand -hex 24)
MEILISEARCH_API_KEY=replace-after-first-boot
MEILI_SEARCH_API_KEY=replace-after-first-boot
CHROMADB_URL=http://localhost:8000
ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=local
OPENROUTER_API_KEY=local
EOF
chmod 600 .env
```

Check: type `ls -la .env`. You should see a file of about 2 KB.

Never share or upload the `.env` file. It holds your passwords.

Step 4. Start KDL OS

```
docker compose up -d --build
```

The first time it takes **10 to 20 minutes**. This is normal. Later starts take seconds.

When it finishes, check:

```
docker compose ps
```

Wait until `backend` says **healthy** (about 1 minute).

Step 5. Create the admin user

```
docker compose exec backend node prisma/seed.js
```

You should see `Seeded admin: admin@kdl.com`.

Step 6. Open KDL OS and log in

1. Open your browser: **http://localhost/loginSMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_165SMART-PANTS_PRESERVED_166SMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_167**
2. **Email:** `admin@kdl.com`
3. **Password:** `kdl-dev-seed-password`
4. **KDL OS asks you to choose a new password. Do it and remember it.**

Done. KDL OS is running.

What you will see next

A question pops up: “Do you need a front-end website?”

Your choice	What happens
Yes	A 5-page website is made for you: Home, About, Services, Contact, FAQ. You can change everything later.
No	Nothing is made. You use the admin only.
Ask me later	The question comes back next time.

Want more content (FAQ, Gallery, Team, Testimonials …)? Open Modules → find CMS → click Install. One click adds all of them.

Change the menu on your website: open CMS → Navigation. Drag the items to change the order.

Every day

Run these inside the `kdl-os` folder.

I want to	Type this
Stop KDL OS (keeps my data)	`docker compose down`
Start it again	`docker compose up -d`
See what is running	`docker compose ps`
Update to the latest code	`git pull` then `docker compose up -d --build`
I forgot my admin password	`docker compose exec backend node scripts/reset-admin-password.js --email admin@kdl.com --password 'NewPassword123'`

Warning: `docker compose down -v` deletes all your data. Do not use it unless you want to start from zero.

If something goes wrong

Problem	What to do
Error says a variable is missing	You are in the wrong folder, or Step 3 was not done. Go to the `kdl-os` folder and repeat Step 3.
"Port is already in use"	Another program is using it. Close that program (for example a local website on port 80).
Build stops with "Killed" or "out of memory"	Give Docker 8 GB (Step 1), then run Step 4 again.
Page shows "502 Bad Gateway"	Wait 1 or 2 minutes and refresh. KDL OS is still starting.
Login says wrong password	Did you run Step 5? Use `kdl-dev-seed-password` the first time.
"Account locked"	Wait 1 minute and try again.

Still stuck? Read the full guide: `docs/INSTALLATION_GUIDE.md`.

Windows setup

Do this once, before Step 2. After this, type every command in the Ubuntu window, not in PowerShell.

1. Click Start, type PowerShell, right-click it, choose Run as administrator.
2. Type `wsl --install` and press Enter. Restart the computer when asked.
3. An Ubuntu window opens. Choose a username and password.
4. Install Docker Desktop (Step 1). In Docker Desktop go to Settings → Resources → WSL integration and switch Ubuntu on.
5. In the Ubuntu window type `cd ~` and then continue from Step 2.

Open http://localhost/loginSMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_382SMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_383 in your normal Windows browser.